

WinGate

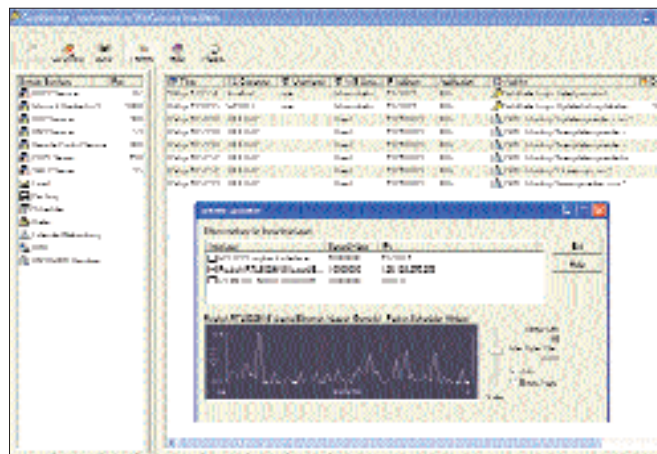
The most eye-catching aspect of WinGate is the clean layout. With its monitoring features, it could be useful for small offices. WinGate provides services under two categories—system and user. System services are programs that provide services such as DHCP, DNS, GDP, SOCKS, remote control and Web server. User services do not provide a service of their own; instead, they forward requests to other servers to get the work done—such as WWW, POP3, FTP, Telnet, Streamworks and RTSP proxies.

The software doesn't have bandwidth management, but it does provide excellent monitoring. Its assumed-user feature lets you assign full names based on either the machine name or the IP address, so all activity is logged under the person's name, rather than under the computer name or IP address.

WinGate also provides Traffic Monitor—a graphical interface that shows traffic in real-time. This provides a bird's-eye view for the system administrator to monitor current usage. It also has a history viewer, which helps track usage histories of individual users. An administrator can administer the proxy server from a remote location as well, using just a web browser.

The software brings along quite a number of goodies, such as an integrated mail server and integrated VPN. Additionally, plug-ins for virus scans and content filtering are available separately.

A whole bunch of maintenance activities are pre-defined within the software. With an in-built scheduler, scheduling events such as 'Roll over logfiles', 'Roll over audit files', 'Purge history database', 'Purge cache', etc. is a piece of cake.



Traffic Monitor provides a real-time picture of bandwidth usage

Though it lacks a few features such as proxy cascading and doesn't have a shared cache, it performs decently. The bundled accessories are a bonus, making it a decent solution for your office.

- + Traffic monitoring; free firewall; integrated mail server
- No proxy cascading; no shared cache

Price: \$149.95

Web site: <http://www.wingate.com/product-wingate.php>

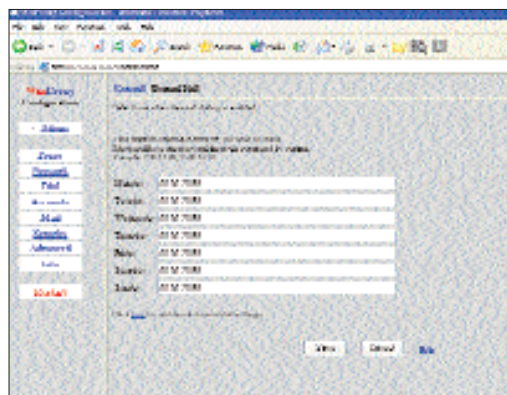
WinGate	B+
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶
Ease of Use	▶▶▶▶▶
Overall	▶▶▶▶▶

WinProxy Pro

The unique aspect of WinProxy Pro is that in the implementation of shared cache, it provides the administrator control over the size of the cache for each of the proxies separately. There are separate limits for cache size, as well as for TTL for HTTP, FTP and Gopher servers.

Security enforcement can be applied by creating users and groups with each user having a username and password to access the Internet. To extend security functionality, WinProxy Pro supports an IP list, similar to the whitelist. This is a much better approach towards limiting users, as Internet access will be available only to the IPs specified in the list.

The software records details of failed login attempts. This information can be used



WinProxy lets you configure the time intervals depending on day of week for demand dialling

by the system administrator to watch out for people trying to break in. A slightly tweaked demand-dial is a great management tool. Here, you can specify the time intervals during which demand dial is enabled.

However, WinProxy Pro doesn't allow a P2P application on the client to get connected—which means most ports are blocked. This could be troublesome to companies relying on special programs that need some ports to be open.

- + User and group creation, mail servers, time interval for demand dial
- No bandwidth monitoring and management, no client-install

Price: \$99

Web site: www.winproxy.net

WinProxy Pro	B+
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶
Ease of Use	▶▶▶▶▶
Overall	▶▶▶▶▶

Info

■ In port mapping, packets arriving at a particular port are forwarded to another IP address, in conjunction with the configured destination port. The configuration comprises five components: a protocol, the listen IP, the listen port, the destination IP and the destination port.

■ Network Address Translation (NAT), an Internet draft standard protocol, is used for hiding your private network behind a single address or multiple addresses. A similar technique known as IP masquerading has been extensively used in the Linux world.